Sample form, not for offline completion.

Visit https://discourse.grantplatform.com to apply.

Round 2 Pilot Project

Pilot projects of up to £15k total budget in any area relevant to DisCouRSE's aims. This category is focused on enabling and exploring new ideas, so **those who received funding in round 1 as lead or co-lead are not eligible to apply**. We are particularly seeking applications from organisations that were not represented in round 1 projects.

Application name

Expected start date

Projects should start between 01/09/2026 and 01/12/2026.

Expected end date

Projects must end by 30/11/2027.

Summary

In plain English, provide a summary of your proposal that we can publish on our website if funded. Do not include any confidential or sensitive information. 200 words

Make it suitable for a variety of readers, for example:

- opinion-formers
- policymakers
- the public
- the wider research community

Clearly describe your proposed work in terms of:

- context
- the challenge(s) related to digital research technical professional leadership skills and careers that you will address
- aims and objectives
- potential impact and benefits

Project Team

Please give details of all individuals who will lead this project.

1. Applications must be led by digital Research Technical Professionals, and we are interested in the profession with which you most closely identify.
2. Each co-lead will receive an email after submission asking them to provide optional EDI data. This will not be used in assessing proposals and will not be seen by reviewers. It will purely be used for analysis of submission patterns and funding outcomes by DisCouRSE and our independent advisory board as a guard against bias.

Name

Leads and co-leads must be named individuals. For team members you may give a role description rather than a name if the precise person is not yet known.

Role

- ◯ Lead
- ◯ Co-lead
- ◯ Team member

Each project must have one overall lead but may have many co-leads and other team members.

Email address

Organisation

Organisation type

UK higher education

UK eligible research organisation

UK business

UK third sector

UK government

Non-UK research organisation

Non-UK business

Non-UK third sector

Division or department (optional)

Profession

Bioinformatician

Community manager

Data engineer

Data manager

Data scientist, analyst, AI or machine learning specialist

Data steward

DevOps engineer

Digital Humanities technologist

Digital librarian or Archivist

HPC or Research Computing specialist

...

Academic discipline(s)
i.e. the disciplines that you primarily work with.

☐ Arts and Humanities

- [ ] Computer Science
- [ ] Engineering and Technology
- [ ] Life Sciences
- [ ] Mathematical Science
- [ ] Physical Sciences
- [ ] Social Sciences
- [ ] Other
- [ ] None of the above

%FTE to be worked on the project

On average what proportion of their time will this person devote to the project? Include both time funded by DisCouRSE and any in-kind contribution; the breakdown should be specified under 'Resources & Cost Justification'.

Vision

Describe the overall aims of the project, setting out the problem you are trying to solve or the change you are seeking to achieve. List your intended outcomes. How do these align to the objectives of the call and the DisCouRSE network aims? 200 words

What the assessors are looking for in your response
We want to see that:
• your proposal's aims are aligned to the priorities of the DisCouRSE network
• the expected outcomes of the project are clear and relevant
• the work is timely and needed, e.g. addressing an unmet need in the digital RTP community
• you have clearly identified the beneficiaries of your work and how they will benefit

For **growth projects** describe how you have already engaged with the community initiative being extended.

Approach

How will you achieve your aims? Include just enough detail to assess feasibility, with a timeline of activities / key milestones. 200 words

What the assessors are looking for in your response

Explain how you have designed your approach so that it:

- is effective and appropriate to achieve your objectives
- is committed to openness and sharing with the community
- will maximise translation of outputs into outcomes and impacts

---

Risks & Mitigations

What are the major risks that might prevent achieving your intended outcomes, and how will you mitigate these? How will you assess whether the project has been a success, over the short, medium, and long term? 200 words

What the assessors are looking for in your response

Show that you:

- are aware of how to assess whether your outcomes have been achieved
- have identified risks to this delivery and how they will be managed

---

Responsible research and innovation (RRI)

What are the ethical or RRI implications of your work? Consider environmental sustainability in particular. How will you ensure that the future digital RTP leadership community is built in an equitable, diverse, and inclusive manner? 150 words

What the assessors are looking for in your response

Explain how you:

- will build EDI considerations into your activities
- will seek to limit adverse environmental impacts

Team capability to deliver

Why are you the right team to deliver the proposed work successfully? Use a narrative format to showcase the range of relevant skills you, and if relevant your team (co-leads, researchers, technicians, specialists, partners and so on) have and how this will help to deliver the proposed work. You can include individuals' specific achievements but only choose past contributions that best evidence their ability to deliver this work.
Note that you do **not** need to use the Résumé for Research and Innovation (R4RI) module headings. 200 words

What the assessors are looking for in your response

Evidence of how you and your team have:

- the relevant experience (appropriate to career stage) and organisational support to deliver the proposed work
- the right balance of skills and expertise to cover the proposed work
- the appropriate leadership and management skills to deliver the work
- contributed to developing a positive research environment and wider community

---

Resources & Cost Justification

What will you need to deliver your proposed work and how much will it cost? 200 words

What the assessors are looking for in your response

Justify the application's more costly resources, in particular:

- project staff
- travel and subsistence estimates for events

Assessors are not looking for detailed costs or a line-by-line breakdown of all project resources.

Overall, they want to be assured that:

- all resources are appropriate and justified
- the project will make optimal use of resources to achieve the intended outcomes
- the staff time required has been realistically assessed and costed sufficiently

100% FEC Budget Requested

Enter the total full economic cost across all co-applicants here for each heading. The overall budget must not exceed £15,000. Further details of the budget breakdown will be required if you are successful to ensure funds can be distributed appropriately.

	Summary Fund Heading	Fund Heading	Full Economic Cost
1	Directly Incurred	Staff	
2		Travel & Subsistence	
3		Other Costs	
4	Directly Allocated	Staff	
5		Estates	
6		Other directly allocated	
7	Indirect Costs	Indirect Costs	
8	Exceptions	Staff	
9		Other Costs	

List costs for business, third sector, and government organisations that are paid at 100% FEC (as opposed to the normal 80% FEC) in the 'Exceptions' rows.

Organisational Approval

☐ The project lead is eligible within their own organisation to be a recipient of the grant funding, and this has been approved by the individual's organisation's relevant internal sign off processes.

Proof of internal approval, e.g. screenshot or email

Provide the email address of a finance and research support contact for the application who will be able to action the award agreement if funded, and can confirm internal approval.

Name of the support contact above

EDIA

These refer to the overall project lead only. While they are required, you may answer 'prefer not to say' in each case. Information provided here will not be used in assessing proposals and will not be seen by reviewers. It will purely be used for analysis of submission patterns and funding outcomes by DisCouRSE and our independent advisory board as a guard against bias.

Gender

- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ Male
- ◯ Female
- ◯ Other

Ethnicity

- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ Asian or Asian British
- ◯ Black, Black British, Caribbean or African
- ◯ Mixed or multiple ethnic groups
- ◯ White
- ◯ Other ethnic group

Career stage

- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ Early
- ◯ Mid
- ◯ Established